ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE O

Measure O asks Rio Vista voters to extend the existing three-quarter-percent (¾ %) sales tax for another three years to fund “general city services,” including police, fire, parks, and other unrestricted expenditures.

The City has not solved its underlying budget problems and now asks residents to continue paying higher taxes without accountability. While the measure sounds routine, it actually continues a temporary tax that was supposed to expire. Sales tax increases make everyday purchases more expensive, groceries, clothing, school supplies, and basic necessities. Families already struggling with rising costs will feel this burden immediately.

Rio Vista residents have already paid this extra tax for years. The City promised that the revenue would stabilize essential services and allow time to build a sustainable budget. Yet here we are again, being asked to extend the same tax because the City has not solved its underlying financial management problems. Extending a “temporary” tax repeatedly turns it into a permanent tax by installments, undermining voter trust.

The funds from Measure O go into the City’s general fund, meaning they can be used for any purpose the City Council chooses. There is no guarantee that the money will improve police staffing, fire protection, or park maintenance. Without dedicated funding or independent oversight, taxpayers have no assurance that the extension will deliver measurable results.

The City projects $1.4 million to $1.47 million in annual revenue, a significant amount for a small community. Before asking residents to continue paying higher prices on every purchase, the City should demonstrate how previous tax revenues were spent and what efficiencies have been achieved. Measure O offers neither transparency nor accountability.

Rio Vista deserves a responsible, transparent budget, not another short-term tax extension that postpones real fiscal reform.

Vote NO on Measure O.

s/ Michael T Nolan, President
Solano County Taxpayers Association